



Press Release

Mines Secretary inaugurates Hind Copper's Nickel plant at Ghatsila

Kolkata, 10.08.2016

Shri Balvinder Kumar, Secretary, Ministry of Mines, inaugurated the Nickel, Copper and Acid Recovery Plant of Hindustan Copper Limited in Indian Copper Complex, Ghatsila, Jharkhand, on 10.08.2016. This is the first facility in India to produce Nickel metal of LME grade from primary resource.

Shri Kumar was welcomed by S/Shri K D Diwan, Chairman-cum-Managing Director, Anupam Anand, Director (Personnel), V V Venugopal Rao, Director (Finance), S .K. Bhattacharya, Director (Mining), Santosh Sharma, Director (Operations), D.K.Choudhury, GM, ICC, and Sanjay Kr. Singh DGM(W), ICC.

The Singhbhum Copper Belt has unique ore characteristics which contains appreciable quantity of Nickel. HCL has installed and commissioned the technology to recover the Nickel metal.

This project will utilize an eco-friendly technology and will check pollution, eliminate the use of Lead, reduce liquid effluent, generate 75% less solid waste, utilize less energy, provide safe working environment and utilize and conserve natural resources.

At present the capacity of the plant is 50 MT per annum, considering the current production rate from the Surda mines. The Nickel output is expected to increase by eight times after the completion of mine expansion projects located at Ghatsila. The annual demand for pure Nickel in India is around 45,000 MT and its market in the country is totally dependent on import.

Currently, Copper is recovered from bleed electrolyte as liberator cathode having only 50-90% Copper content, and liberator sludge with 50-60% Copper content. Interestingly, the process consumes around 30 MT LME-A grade Copper starter sheet per annum.

The proposed project will replace the age-old process of liberator cell operation with EMEW & APU technology in the Refinery.



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